

To make sure this change took effect, visit the `/topics/999/` URL again. You should see just the message *Server Error (500)*, with no sensitive information about the project at all.

Creating Custom Error Pages

In Chapter 19, we configured Learning Log to return a 404 error if the user requests a topic or entry that doesn't belong to them. Now you've seen a 500 server error as well. A 404 error usually means your Django code is correct, but the object being requested doesn't exist. A 500 error usually means there's an error in the code you've written, such as an error in a function in *views.py*. Django currently returns the same generic error page in both situations, but we can write our own 404 and 500 error page templates that match Learning Log's overall appearance. These templates belong in the root template directory.

Making Custom Templates

In the *learning_log* folder, make a new folder called *templates*. Then make a new file called *404.html*; the path to this file should be *learning_log/templates/404.html*. Here's the code for this file:

```
404.html {% extends "learning_logs/base.html" %}

{% block page_header %}
    <h2>The item you requested is not available. (404)</h2>
{% endblock page_header %}
```

This simple template provides the generic 404 error page information but is styled to match the rest of the site.

Make another file called *500.html* using the following code:

```
500.html {% extends "learning_logs/base.html" %}

{% block page_header %}
    <h2>There has been an internal error. (500)</h2>
{% endblock page_header %}
```

These new files require a slight change to *settings.py*.

```
settings.py --snip--
TEMPLATES = [
    {
        'BACKEND': 'django.template.backends.django.DjangoTemplates',
        'DIRS': [BASE_DIR / 'templates'],
        'APP_DIRS': True,
        --snip--
    },
]
--snip--
```
